THE MARKETING MANAGEMENT STUDY TEXT

Marketing Management

Unit III • Web Analytics, Google Analytics and E-mail Marketing

IM345AT • Semester IV • Volume 3 of 5

RV College of Engineering, Bengaluru – 59
Department of Industrial Engineering and Management
An Autonomous Institution Affiliated to VTU

THE MARKETING MANAGEMENT STUDY TEXT

Marketing Management

Course Code IM345AT • Semester IV
L:T:P 3:0:0 • 45 Hours • Professional Core Course

UNIT III

Web Analytics, Google Analytics and E-mail Marketing

Measurement, reporting, and the owned channel with the highest conversion rate in digital marketing

Syllabus allocation: 07 Hours

3

Volume 3 of 5 • Unofficial student study text • 2026 edition

Marketing Management — The Study Text
Volume 3 of 5 • Unit III: Web Analytics, Google Analytics and E-mail Marketing

Prepared for the course Marketing Management (IM345AT), Semester IV, of the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management, RV College of Engineering, Bengaluru – 59.

Sources. The syllabus, course outcomes, assessment rubrics and reference-book list reproduced in the front matter are transcribed from the official course document. The previous-year questions in Appendix B are transcribed from RVCE Continuous Internal Evaluation and Semester End Examination papers for this course, and where an official scheme of valuation was released the model answers follow it. The explanatory text is compiled from classroom lecture notes and, where those were incomplete, from the prescribed reference texts.

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Status. Unofficial student-compiled study material. Not issued, endorsed or verified by the Department or by RV College of Engineering.

2026 edition.

Preface to Volume 3

Unit III is where digital marketing stops being persuasion and becomes measurement. The two halves of the unit are the instrument and the channel: web analytics is how a business finds out what actually happened, and e-mail marketing is the one channel whose audience the business owns outright.

The connection between them is not incidental. Web analytics converts anonymous traffic into evidence, and without it digital marketing forfeits the single structural advantage it holds over traditional marketing — measurability. E-mail is the channel that most rewards that evidence, because it is the only major channel where the marketer can segment, personalise, trigger and re-send without asking an algorithm's permission.

Chapters 1 to 3 cover web analytics and Google Analytics; Chapters 4 to 7 cover e-mail marketing. The chapter sequence follows the syllabus phrase order exactly, and Appendix A records the mapping.

One characteristic of this unit deserves stating in advance, because it changes how the material should be learned. Almost every past-paper question in Unit III is *applied*: you are given a business — an e-commerce site, an e-learning platform, a travel agency, a skincare startup, an online business targeting college students — and asked to build a plan or diagnose a failure. General commentary scores badly on such questions. What scores is a named framework applied to the specific case. This volume therefore states each framework explicitly and by name — the six-stage measurement funnel, the seven-node e-mail plan, the eight-step goal setup, the eight-step segmentation guide — and then works it through on a real scenario so the pattern is visible.

Unlike Volumes 1 and 2, this volume has no appendix of off-syllabus material. Every topic in the source notes for Unit III maps to a phrase in the unit descriptor, so nothing had to be set aside.

The whole of the course syllabus is reproduced overleaf. The unit covered by this volume is Unit III.

How to Use This Study Text

The shape of a volume

Each of the five volumes in this series covers exactly one unit of the IM345AT syllabus and is self-contained. Every volume opens with the official syllabus for the whole course, so that the unit in hand can always be located within it, and closes with a set of appendices carrying the concordance, the question bank, the glossary and a quick-reference sheet.

The numbered chapters of each volume map one-to-one onto the topic phrases of that unit's official syllabus descriptor. The order of the chapters is the order of the syllabus. Appendix A sets out that mapping explicitly, phrase by phrase, so coverage can be audited rather than assumed.

The five panel types

Material that is not continuous prose is set in one of five panels. Each has a fixed meaning throughout the series.

DEFINITION • the term being defined

A formal definition, worth reproducing close to verbatim in an answer script. The term appears in the panel heading and again in the index.

HIGH YIELD

A result, list or distinction that carries disproportionate examination weight. Where a topic has recurred across papers, the recurrence is recorded as a bracketed tag. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026)

MODEL ANSWER

An answer written at the length and in the register the marking scheme rewards. Where an official scheme of valuation was released, the panel follows it.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A concrete illustration — a named company, a named persona, a worked calculation — rather than a general statement.

CAUTION

A common and costly error: a distinction usually collapsed, a term usually misused, or an answer that looks complete and is not.

A sixth panel, in green, sets out a framework or process as a single sequence:

FRAMEWORK

Step one → step two → step three → back to step one.

How previous-year questions are recorded

THE BRACKET CONVENTION

A past-paper appearance is recorded **only** as a bracketed source tag attached to the material, never as a sentence of narrative. So the text reads

> Push versus pull marketing. (CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M)

and never "this was asked in 2025 and again in 2026". The tag carries the paper, the date and, where the mark allocation is known, the marks. Multiple appearances are separated by semicolons.

The abbreviations used inside tags are:

CIE-I	First Continuous Internal Evaluation test
CIE-II	Second Continuous Internal Evaluation test
CIE-III	Third Continuous Internal Evaluation test
SEE	Semester End Examination
2 M	Mark allocation of the question as printed on the paper

Appendix B of each volume reproduces every past-paper question traced to that unit, in full, grouped by mark weight, each carrying the same bracketed tag.

Cross-references, figures and the index

Cross-references are given as § chapter.section — so § 1.4 is the fourth section of Chapter 1. Every figure in this series is drawn in TEX rather than imported as an image, so the diagrams print at full resolution at any size and use the same typeface as the surrounding text. Figures and tables are listed after the table of contents.

Terms set in ***bold italic*** on first use are indexed. The index at the back of each volume is a real back-of-book index built from those terms, not a repeat of the contents list.

Status of this text

UNOFFICIAL DOCUMENT

This is a student-compiled study text. It is not issued, endorsed or verified by the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management or by RV College of Engineering. The syllabus reproduced in the front matter, the assessment rubrics and the previous-year questions are transcribed from official documents; the explanatory prose around them is not official. Where the source lecture notes were incomplete, gaps have been filled from the prescribed reference texts listed in the front matter. Always cross-check against the official syllabus and your own class notes.

Official Syllabus: IM345AT

Reproduced from the official course document issued by the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management, RV College of Engineering. The text of the five unit descriptors below is the authority against which every chapter of this series is written; nothing outside it appears in the numbered chapters of any volume.

Semester: IV • MARKETING MANAGEMENT

Category: Professional Core Course (Theory)

Course Code	IM345AT	**CIE Marks**	100 Marks
Credits (L:T:P)	3:0:0	**SEE Marks**	100 Marks
Total Hours	45 L	**SEE Duration**	3.00 Hours

UNIT–I 07 Hrs

Introduction to Digital Marketing: Principles of Digital Marketing; Digital Marketing Channels; Tools to Create Buyer Persona; Competitor Research Tools, Website Analysis Tools, etc.

Content Marketing: Content Marketing Concepts & Strategies; Planning, Creating, Distributing & Promoting Content; Optimize Website UX & Landing Pages; Measure Impact; Metrics & Performance; Using Content Research for Opportunities, etc.

UNIT–II 08 Hrs

Social Media Marketing: Introduction; Major Social Media Platforms for Marketing; Developing Data-driven Audience & Campaign Insights; Social Media for Business; Creation & Optimization of Social Media Campaigns, etc.

Search Engine Optimization: Search Engine Optimization Fundamentals; Keywords and SEO Content Plan; SEO & Business Objectives; Writing SEO Content; On-site & off-site SEO; Optimize Organic Search Ranking, etc.

UNIT–III 07 Hrs

Web Analytics & Google Analytics: Google Analytics Tools; Web Analytics Tools, etc.

E-mail Marketing: Effective E-mail Campaigns; E-mail Plan; E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis; Measuring Conversions & keeping up, etc.

UNIT–IV 07 Hrs

Web Design: Web design, optimization of websites; Publishing a basic website; User-centered Design and Website Optimization; Design Principles and Website Copy; Website Metrics & Developing Insight, etc.

Mobile Marketing: Difference between mobile advertising and marketing, utilizing mobile marketing for sales promotions, online applications, etc.

UNIT–V 07 Hrs

Conversion Optimization: What is AIDAS and its role; website optimization; what visitors want to see on the website; how to optimize key element and increase the effect of landing on a particular page

Digital Analytics: Evolution of Digital Analytics, information about end-to-end customer experience, analyst's influence on business, role as a change agent, etc.

Course Outcomes

After completing the course, the students will be able to:

CO1	Differentiate the benefits drawn by updated marketing mix from traditional marketing mix for effective marketing management there by to stay competitive in today's global market-place.
CO2	Develop an effective holistic marketing atmosphere to efficiently face the challenges in dynamically changing market.
CO3	Formulate a potential marketing plan to effectively reach the targeted market segments, by delivering the value to targeted customers through practicing sound marketing research.
CO4	Create new channels to improvise marketing to achieve and maintain competitive position in globalized market-place.

Prescribed Reference Books

1. *Marketing Management*, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, 15th Edition, 2016, Pearson, ISBN: 978-93-325-5718-5.
2. *Digital Marketing — Strategy, Implementation & Practice*, Dave Chaffey, Fiona Ellis-Chadwick, 7th Edition, 2019, Pearson, ISBN: 9781292241623, 1292241624.
3. *Marketing Research*, Donald S. Tull, Del I. Hawkins, 6th Edition, Prentice Hall India, ISBN: 8120309618.
4. *Marketing Management — A South Asian Perspective*, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, Abraham Koshy, Mithileshwar Jha, 14th Edition, 2013, Pearson, ISBN: 978-81-317-6716-0.
5. *Marketing Research*, David A. Aaker, V. Kumar, George S. Day, 9th Edition, 2008, John Wiley & Sons, ISBN: 978-265-1791-6.

Assessment Scheme

Rubric for the Continuous Internal Evaluation (Theory)

#	Component	Marks
1.	**Quizzes:** Quizzes will be conducted in online/offline mode. TWO QUIZZES will be conducted & each quiz will be evaluated for 10 marks. The sum of two quizzes will be the final quiz marks.	**20**
2.	**Tests:** Students will be evaluated in test, descriptive questions with different complexity levels (Revised Bloom's Taxonomy Levels: Remembering, Understanding, Applying, Analyzing, Evaluating and Creating). TWO tests will be conducted. Each test will be evaluated for 50 marks, adding up to 100 marks. Final test marks will be reduced to 40 marks.	**40**
3.	**Experiential Learning:** Students will be evaluated for their creativity and practical implementation of the problem. Case study-based teaching learning (10), Program specific requirements (10), Video based seminar/presentation/demonstration (20), adding up to 40.	**40**
MAXIMUM MARKS FOR THE CIE THEORY		**100**

Rubric for the Semester End Examination (Theory)

Q. No.	Contents	Marks
PART A		
1	Objective type questions covering entire syllabus	**20**
PART B	*(Maximum of TWO sub-divisions only)*	
2	Unit 1: (Compulsory)	**16**
3 & 4	Unit 2: (Internal Choice)	**16**
5 & 6	Unit 3: (Internal Choice)	**16**
7 & 8	Unit 4: (Internal Choice)	**16**
9 & 10	Unit 5: (Internal Choice)	**16**
TOTAL		**100**

WHAT THE SEE STRUCTURE MEANS FOR THIS VOLUME

Part A draws twenty marks of objective questions from the *entire* syllabus, so no unit can be skipped. In Part B, Question 2 is compulsory and is always set from Unit I; Units II to V each carry a 16-mark internal-choice pair. A candidate therefore answers Unit I plus one question from each of the remaining four units — five full questions in all.

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CHAPTER 1

Web Analytics — Fundamentals and Role

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Web Analytics & Google Analytics.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- What web analytics is, and why it matters in digital marketing.
- Traditional marketing analysis against web analytics-based analysis.
- The three metric families: volume, quality, action.
- The core metrics, precisely defined — including the distinction between bounce rate and exit rate, and between dimensions and metrics.
- The dual lens of website analytics and social analytics.
- The eight roles of web analytics and the seven benefits of analysing site data.
- How to align analytics KPIs with organisational goals.
- A/B testing and conversion rate optimisation.

1.1 Definition and Importance

DEFINITION • Web Analytics

Web analytics is the process of collecting, measuring, analysing and reporting website data in order to understand and optimise web usage. (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M)

Importance in digital marketing: it helps understand customer behaviour; measures campaign effectiveness; improves website performance; and supports better marketing decisions.

WHY THIS IS THE FOUNDATION OF THE WHOLE DISCIPLINE

Web analytics converts anonymous traffic into evidence. Without it, digital marketing loses the one structural advantage it holds over traditional marketing — measurability.

1.2 Traditional Marketing Analysis Against Web Analytics

HIGH YIELD

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M) Learn at least seven rows, and attach an example to each.

Table 1.1. Traditional marketing analysis against web analytics-based analysis

Aspect	Traditional Marketing Analysis	Web Analytics-Based Analysis
Data collection	Surveys and interviews	Real-time online tracking
Speed	Slow	Instant
Accuracy	Limited — relies on recall and self-reporting	Highly accurate — records actual behaviour
Customer tracking	Difficult	Easy
Cost	Expensive	Cost-effective
Measurement	Estimated results	Measurable KPIs
Sample	A sample of respondents	The entire population of visitors
Attribution	Largely guesswork	Channel- and campaign-level attribution
Feedback loop	Post-campaign	Continuous, mid-campaign
Example	A focus group is asked whether an advertisement was memorable	Google Analytics shows exactly how many people saw the advertisement, clicked, browsed and purchased

1.3 The Three Metric Families

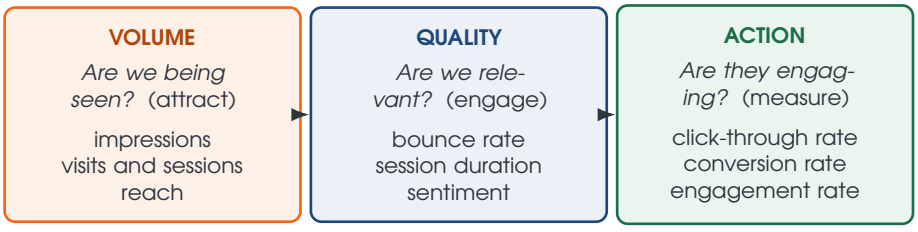


Figure 1.1. The three families in sequence. A reading in one family cannot be interpreted without the others: high volume with poor quality is wasted acquisition, and good quality with no action is a missing call to action.

Table 1.2. The three metric families

Family	Question it answers	Metrics
Volume	Are we being seen? (attract)	**Impressions** — the number of times content is seen. **Visits or sessions** — total times people have been to the site. **Reach** — total users receiving brand content.

Family	Question it answers	Metrics
Quality	Are we relevant? (engage)	**Bounce rate** — people arriving and leaving without visiting another page. **Session duration** — time spent per visit. **Sentiment** — positive, negative or neutral brand mentions.
Action	Are they engaging? (measure)	**Click-through rate** — the percentage of people who see content and click. **Conversion rate** — the percentage who buy against who arrived. **Engagement rate** — the ratio of people taking action to the total who saw the content.

1.4 Core Metrics, Precisely Defined

Users or unique visitors The number of distinct individuals who visited the site in a period, de-duplicated by client identifier.

Sessions or visits A group of interactions by one user within a given time frame. A single user may generate many sessions.

Pageviews The total number of pages loaded. *Unique* pageviews counts a page once per session.

Bounce rate The percentage of visitors who leave a website after viewing only one page without any interaction.

Exit rate The percentage of sessions that ended on a given page.

Average session duration The mean time users spend per session; a proxy for content depth and interest.

Pages per session The average number of pages viewed per session; a measure of site exploration.

Conversion rate The percentage of sessions or users completing a defined goal — purchase, sign-up, download, enquiry.

Goal or conversion A specific, valuable, trackable user action that the site is designed to produce.

Acquisition channel The grouping that describes where a session came from — organic search, paid search, direct, referral, social, e-mail, display.

New against returning visitors The split between first-time and repeat users; a retention signal.

BOUNCE RATE IS NOT EXIT RATE

Every session that bounces also exits, but not every exit is a bounce. A bounce is a single-page session with no interaction; an exit is simply the last page of *any* session.

The practical consequence: an exit is not necessarily a failure. An order-confirmation page *should* have a high exit rate, because the user has finished. Treating exit rate as a fault indicator therefore leads to 'optimising' pages that are already working.

DEFINITION • Dimensions and Metrics

Dimensions are the *attributes* of the data — the qualitative descriptors that answer "what" or "where": city, device, browser, source and medium, page path, landing page.

Metrics are the *quantitative* measurements — the numbers: sessions, users, pageviews, bounce rate, revenue.

In a report, dimensions form the rows and metrics form the columns. (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M)

1.5 Bounce Rate and Website Performance Assessment

MODEL ANSWER — 2 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M) Bounce rate is the percentage of visitors who leave a website after viewing only one page without any interaction.

Effect on performance evaluation. A high bounce rate indicates that visitors are not finding what they expected — signalling poor content relevance, slow page load, confusing design, weak calls to action or mismatched traffic. It therefore acts as an early diagnostic of both *content quality* and *traffic quality*, and correlates with lower conversion rates.

ALWAYS READ BOUNCE RATE IN CONTEXT

A high bounce is not automatically a fault. A blog post that answers a question completely, or a contact page that supplies a phone number, may legitimately show a high bounce rate because the visitor's need was met on that single page. The diagnosis depends on what the page was *for*.

1.6 The Dual Lens — Website Analytics and Social Analytics

Table 1.3. The website footprint and the social echo

	The Website Footprint	The Social Echo
Focus	On-site behaviour and technical specifications	Off-site popularity and brand conversation
Key data	Device type, make and model; browser, resolution, operating system; language and location; new against returning visitors; traffic sources; funnel conversion from start to end of purchase	Mentions; followers; buzz, a combined popularity measure; share of voice, conversations about you against the competition; sentiment
Major players	Google Analytics, Adobe Analytics, Webtrends	Facebook Insights, X Analytics, Hootsuite

1.7 The Role of Web Analytics in Digital Marketing

HIGH YIELD

"Explain the role of web analytics in digital marketing. How can businesses benefit from analysing website data?" (CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M) The question has two halves; answer both. The roles are what analytics *does*; the benefits are what the business *gets*.

1. **Measurement of effectiveness** — establishes which campaigns, channels and creatives actually produce results.
2. **Understanding customer behaviour** — reveals the real path users take, not the path the business assumed.
3. **Conversion optimisation** — locates the exact step at which prospects abandon.
4. **Budget allocation** — directs spend to the lowest cost per acquisition.
5. **Content strategy** — identifies which topics and formats attract and hold the audience.

6. **Technical improvement** — surfaces slow pages, broken journeys and device-specific failures.
7. **Segmentation and personalisation** — enables different treatment of different audiences.
8. **Forecasting and target-setting** — historical data makes goals realistic and progress measurable.

1.7.1 Benefits of analysing website data

- Higher conversion rates, from evidence-based fixes rather than opinion.
- Lower customer acquisition cost, through better channel allocation.
- Improved user experience and reduced bounce.
- Faster detection of problems — a tracking break, a broken checkout, a traffic collapse.
- Better content decisions and less wasted production effort.
- Demonstrable ROI, which protects and justifies the marketing budget.
- Competitive advantage, from acting on data faster than rivals do.

1.8 Aligning Analytics KPIs With Organisational Goals

MODEL ANSWER — 10 MARKS

(CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)

1. **Identify business goals** — increase sales, brand awareness, lead generation.
2. **Map goals to relevant KPIs.** Sales growth → conversion rate, revenue, cart-abandonment rate. Brand awareness → website traffic, impressions, reach. Lead generation → form submissions, sign-ups. Customer engagement → bounce rate, session duration, pages per visit.
3. **Use SMART KPIs** — Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. For example: increase conversion rate by 10% in three months.
4. **Use analytics tools** — track the KPIs through Google Analytics and dashboards.
5. **Monitor and optimise continuously** — analyse data regularly and modify strategy on the basis of measured performance.

1.9 A/B Testing and Conversion Rate Optimisation

DEFINITION • A/B Testing and CRO

A/B testing, also called split testing, is showing two versions of a page or element to two randomly assigned halves of the traffic simultaneously, and measuring which produces a statistically significantly better outcome on a defined goal.

Conversion rate optimisation (CRO) is the systematic process of increasing the percentage of visitors who complete a desired action, using analytics, user research and controlled experiments.

- **Significance.** It replaces opinion and seniority with evidence; isolates the effect of a single variable; produces compounding gains, since a 10% lift applies to all future traffic at zero additional acquisition cost; reduces the risk of large redesigns by testing incrementally; and reveals genuine user preference, which frequently contradicts internal assumption.
- **What to test.** Headlines; calls to action — text, colour, position; hero images; form length and field order; page layout; pricing presentation; trust signals; and the checkout flow.

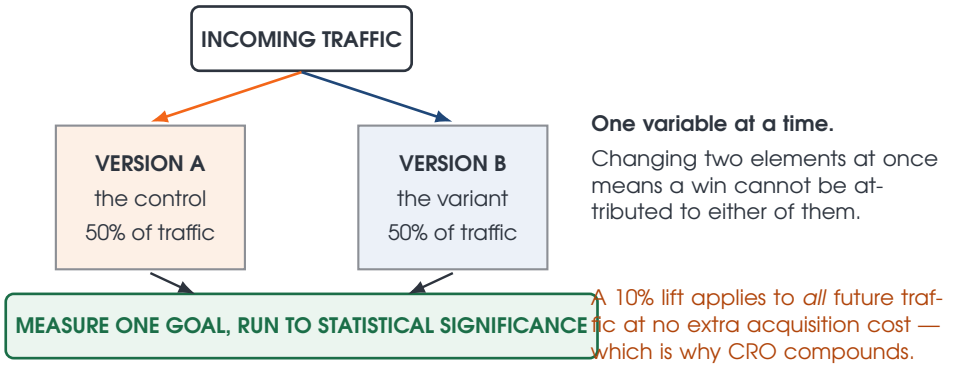


Figure 1.2. A/B testing splits traffic simultaneously rather than sequentially, so that seasonality, campaign timing and traffic-mix changes affect both versions equally.

- **Process.** Analyse data to find the weakest step → form a hypothesis ("shortening the form from nine fields to four will raise submissions") → build the variant → split traffic → run to statistical significance → implement the winner → repeat.
- **Tools.** VWO, Optimizely and AB Tasty for the experiments, plus Hotjar and Microsoft Clarity for the qualitative diagnosis that generates the hypotheses in the first place.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Web analytics collects, measures, analyses and reports website data to understand and optimise web usage; it is what makes digital marketing measurable at all. Against traditional analysis it wins on speed, accuracy, cost, sample size, attribution and the continuity of its feedback loop. Metrics fall into three families — volume, quality and action — and no family can be read alone. Bounce rate is a single-page no-interaction session and must be read in context; exit rate is merely the last page of any session. Dimensions are attributes and form the rows; metrics are numbers and form the columns. Web analytics plays eight roles from measuring effectiveness to forecasting, and yields seven business benefits from higher conversion to demonstrable ROI. KPIs are aligned to goals in five steps. A/B testing and CRO replace opinion with evidence and compound, because a lift applies to all future traffic at no extra acquisition cost.

CHAPTER 2

Google Analytics Tools

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Google Analytics Tools.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The purpose of Google Analytics.
- Its key features — the four to name, and the full list.
- Acquisition channels, and the optimisation action for each.
- The seven report families.
- The eight-step process for setting up and tracking goals.
- Google Tag Manager — its contribution and its governance risks.

2.1 Purpose

MODEL ANSWER — 2 MARKS

(CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M) The main purpose of ***Google Analytics*** is to collect, measure and report data about website and app users — who they are, how they arrived, what they did and whether they converted — so that businesses can understand user behaviour, evaluate marketing performance and make evidence-based decisions to improve traffic quality and conversions.

2.2 Key Features

FOUR FEATURES — 2 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M) (1) Traffic source analysis, (2) bounce rate measurement, (3) user demographics tracking, (4) conversion and goal tracking.

A fuller list, for eight- and ten-mark answers:

- **Real-time reporting** — who is on the site right now, and what they are doing.
- **Audience reports** — demographics, interests, geography, language, technology and device.
- **Acquisition reports** — which channels, sources, mediums and campaigns delivered the traffic.
- **Behaviour and engagement reports** — landing pages, exit pages, site content performance, site search, page load times.
- **Conversion and goal tracking** — destination, duration, pages-per-session and event goals; assigning monetary value to conversions.
- **E-commerce tracking** — product performance, shopping and checkout behaviour, average order value, revenue.

- **Funnel visualisation** — where users drop out of a defined multi-step path.
- **Segments** — isolating a subset of users, for example mobile users from paid search who did not convert.
- **Attribution and model comparison** — how credit for a conversion is distributed across touchpoints.
- **Custom dashboards, reports and alerts.**
- **Audience building and remarketing lists** exported to the advertising platform.
- **Integrations** — Google Ads, Search Console, BigQuery, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio.

2.3 Acquisition Channels

HIGH YIELD

"Discuss the concept of 'Acquisition channels' in Google Analytics. How can business use this information to optimize their marketing efforts?" (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q5a — 8 M)

Table 2.1. Acquisition channels and their optimisation actions

Channel	What it means	Typical optimisation action
Organic search	Unpaid clicks from search engines	Invest in SEO for the pages and queries already converting
Paid search	Clicks from search advertisements	Shift budget to keywords with the lowest cost per conversion
Direct	Users typing the URL or using bookmarks — also the catch-all for untagged traffic	Build brand; audit for missing UTM tags inflating this bucket
Referral	Links from other websites	Nurture the partnerships and publications actually sending buyers
Organic social	Unpaid social posts	Double down on the platform delivering engaged traffic
Paid social	Social advertising	Reallocate spend by cost per result
E-mail	Clicks from e-mail campaigns	Increase send frequency to the highest-converting segments
Display	Banner and remarketing advertisements	Refine placements and exclude low-quality inventory
Affiliates	Partner-driven traffic	Adjust commission by partner quality

HOW THE BUSINESS USES THIS

It identifies which channels deliver not just volume but *converting* volume; it exposes the cost per acquisition of each channel so that budget can be reallocated; it reveals *assisted conversions*, where a channel contributes without taking the last click; it enables channel-specific landing page optimisation; and it prevents the classic error of judging a channel by traffic when it should be judged by revenue.

AN INFLATED "DIRECT" BUCKET IS A MEASUREMENT FAULT

Direct traffic should be people who typed the URL or used a bookmark. In practice it is also where every untagged link ends up — an e-mail without UTM parameters, a link in a PDF, a QR code. A large and growing Direct channel is therefore more often a tagging failure than a brand success, and it silently steals credit from the channels that earned it.

2.4 Report Families

HIGH YIELD

"List and explain the various reports that can be generated using Google Analytics." (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q6b — 8 M)

Table 2.2. The report families in Google Analytics

Report family	What it tells you
Real-time	Active users right now, their pages, sources and locations — used to verify a campaign launch or a tag deployment
Audience / User	Who the visitors are: demographics, interests, geography, language, technology, devices, new against returning, user lifetime value, cohort retention
Acquisition / Traffic acquisition	Where users came from — channel, source and medium, campaign, plus advertising and Search Console integration
Behaviour / Engagement	What users did on the site — pages and screens, landing pages, exit pages, site search, page timings, events
Conversions / Monetisation	Goal completions, goal value, funnel visualisation, e-commerce revenue, product performance, checkout behaviour, purchase journey
Attribution / Advertising	How conversion credit is distributed across touchpoints; model comparison
Custom reports and Explorations	User-defined combinations of dimensions and metrics; funnel explorations, path explorations, segment overlap

2.5 Setting Up and Tracking Goals

HIGH YIELD

"Describe the process of setting up and tracking goals in Google Analytics." (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q10b — 6 M)

1. **Define what a conversion means** for the business — a purchase, a form submission, a newsletter sign-up, a brochure download, a call click.
2. **Choose the goal type** — destination (a thank-you URL is reached), duration (a session exceeds a set time), pages or screens per session, or event (a specific interaction such as a video play or a button click). In GA4 these are configured as events marked as conversions.
3. **Implement the tracking** — deploy the tag via Google Tag Manager, define the trigger, and fire the event on the qualifying action.

4. **Assign a monetary value** to the goal where possible, so that non-transactional conversions can still be compared and optimised.
5. **Configure the funnel** — define the required steps preceding the goal, so that drop-off is visible step by step.
6. **Verify** using real-time reports and debug mode *before* relying on the data.
7. **Track and report** — monitor conversion rate by channel, campaign, device and landing page.
8. **Act on the findings** — fix the step with the largest drop-off, reallocate budget to the highest-converting channels, and A/B test the weakest page.

WHY GOAL TRACKING MATTERS

Without goals, analytics measures *activity* rather than *outcome*. Goals are what convert traffic reports into ROI reports.

2.6 Google Tag Manager

HIGH YIELD

"Critically evaluate the contribution of Google Tag Manager in optimizing marketing channels for global companies." (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q6b — 8 M) The word *critically* requires both halves: the contribution *and* the limitations. An answer giving only the benefits is incomplete.

DEFINITION • Google Tag Manager

Google Tag Manager is a container that lets marketers deploy, edit and version tracking tags without editing site code.

2.6.1 The contribution

- It lets marketers deploy, edit and version tracking tags without a developer, which collapses the change cycle from weeks to minutes.
- It standardises the data layer across dozens of regional sites, so that global reporting is comparable.
- It centralises consent management, which is essential under GDPR and similar regimes.
- It reduces page weight by loading tags asynchronously.
- It enables rapid A/B and campaign experimentation.
- It provides preview and version rollback, reducing the risk of breaking measurement.

2.6.2 The critical view

WHERE TAG MANAGER BECOMES THE PROBLEM

It can become a governance problem: untracked tag sprawl, duplicate conversion firing, degraded page performance, and security exposure if publish rights are granted too widely.

It also does not fix a poor measurement plan. It only makes deploying one faster.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Google Analytics collects, measures and reports data about users — who they are, how they arrived, what they did and whether they converted. The four features to name are traffic source analysis, bounce rate measurement, demographics tracking, and conversion and goal tracking; the fuller list adds real-time, audience, acquisition, behaviour, e-commerce, funnels, segments, attribution, dashboards, remarketing audiences and integrations. Acquisition channels group traffic by origin, each with its own optimisation action, and the purpose of the report is to judge channels by revenue rather than volume. Reports fall into seven families. Goals are configured in eight steps, verified before being trusted, and are what turn traffic reports into ROI reports. Tag Manager collapses the deployment cycle and standardises global measurement, but introduces governance risk and cannot substitute for a measurement plan.

CHAPTER 3

Web Analytics Tools

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Web Analytics Tools.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The main web analytics tools other than Google Analytics, and what each is good at.
- How quantitative and qualitative tools combine — the "what" and the "why".

3.1 Tools Other Than Google Analytics

TWO TOOLS — 2 MARKS

"Name any two popular web analytics tools other than Google Analytics." (CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M) **Adobe Analytics** and **Matomo**. Also acceptable: Webtrends, Mixpanel, Hotjar, Microsoft Clarity, Kissmetrics, Piwik PRO, Heap, Amplitude, Crazy Egg, SimilarWeb.

Table 3.1. Web analytics tools and their strengths

Tool	Strength
Adobe Analytics	Enterprise-grade segmentation, attribution and integration with the Adobe Experience Cloud
Matomo formerly Piwik	Open-source and self-hostable; full data ownership and privacy compliance
Webtrends	A long-established enterprise web analytics platform
Mixpanel and Amplitude	Product analytics — event-based funnels, cohorts and retention for apps and software services
Hotjar, Microsoft Clarity, Crazy Egg	Qualitative behaviour — heatmaps, scroll maps, click maps and session recordings
Kissmetrics	Person-level tracking across sessions and devices
SimilarWeb	Competitive traffic estimation and benchmarking
Google Search Console	Search-side data — impressions, clicks, average position, indexing and Core Web Vitals
Google Tag Manager	Central deployment and version control of all tracking tags without editing site code
Looker Studio	Dashboarding and reporting across multiple data sources

3.2 The Quantitative and the Qualitative

HIGH YIELD

"Demonstrate how tools like Google Analytics and Hotjar can be used to develop insights into user behavior and improve marketing decisions." (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q7a — 8 M) The organising idea for the answer: analytics gives the **what**, behavioural tools give the **why**, and neither is sufficient alone.

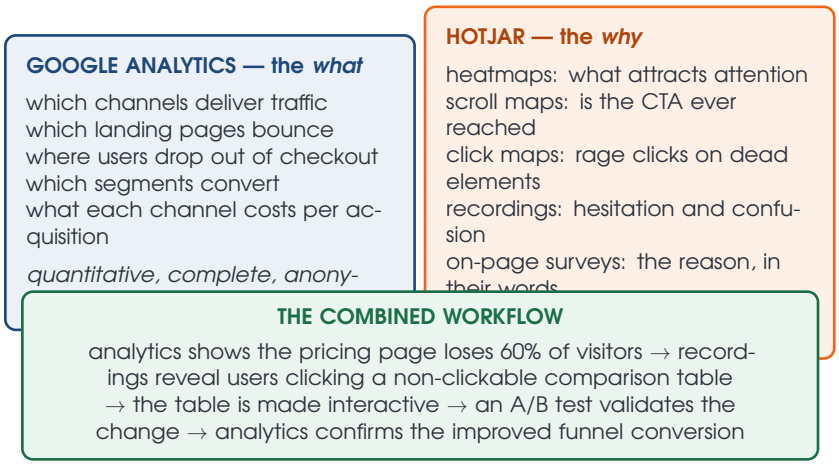


Figure 3.1. Analytics locates the problem; behavioural tools explain it. A funnel report can say *where* users leave but never *why*, and a session recording can show why but never how often.

MARKETING DECISIONS IMPROVED

Budget reallocation, landing page redesign priority, form simplification, content placement and mobile-specific fixes — each grounded in evidence rather than opinion.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Beyond Google Analytics, the toolset divides by job: Adobe Analytics for enterprise attribution, Matomo for self-hosted data ownership, Mixpanel and Amplitude for product event analytics, Hotjar and Clarity for qualitative behaviour, Kissmetrics for person-level tracking, SimilarWeb for competitive benchmarking, Search Console for search-side data, Tag Manager for deployment and Looker Studio for reporting. Quantitative tools answer what happened and how often; qualitative tools answer why. The productive workflow alternates between them: analytics locates a drop-off, recordings explain it, a test validates the fix, and analytics confirms the result.

CHAPTER 4

Effective E-mail Campaigns

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

E-mail Marketing: Effective E-mail Campaigns.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- What e-mail marketing is, and why it is an owned channel.
- E-mail 1.0 against E-mail 2.0.
- The advantages, and the liabilities that come with them.
- Opt-in against spam, and the legal position.
- The anatomy of an effective e-mail — three rules and a checklist.
- The content arsenal: nine e-mail types in three strategic groups.
- Transactional against promotional e-mail.

4.1 What E-mail Marketing Is

DEFINITION • E-mail Marketing

E-mail marketing is the use of e-mail to deliver commercial and relationship-building messages to a permission-based list of subscribers, in order to acquire, engage, convert and retain customers.

It is a vital tool used throughout the entire sales funnel — engaging prospects, maintaining interest and driving key revenue for online retailers at a fraction of the cost of direct mail.

WHY E-MAIL IS STRUCTURALLY DIFFERENT

Every other channel rents its audience. Social reach is granted by an algorithm that can withdraw it; search ranking is granted by an algorithm that can change. An e-mail list is an **owned asset**: no intermediary stands between the message and the recipient, which is why e-mail has the highest conversion and retention rate of any digital channel.

4.2 E-mail 1.0 Against E-mail 2.0

Table 4.1. The generational shift in e-mail marketing

E-mail 1.0	E-mail 2.0
Simple one-way messages	Behaviour-based triggers
Static auto-responders	Segmented targeting based on purchase history and interests
Mass "batch and blast" distribution	Dynamic lifecycle automation

E-mail 1.0	E-mail 2.0
Untracked engagement	Deep tracking metrics

4.3 Advantages

FOUR ADVANTAGES OVER TRADITIONAL METHODS — 2 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M) Low cost; global reach; easy performance tracking; personalised communication.

- **Cost and speed** — cheaper and faster than traditional direct mail.
- **Tracking** — real-time visibility into opens, clicks and conversions.
- **Personalisation** — dynamic tailoring based on collected data.
- **Global reach** at no incremental cost per recipient.
- **Ownership of the channel** — unlike social media, the list is an owned asset that no algorithm can throttle.
- **Highest conversion and retention rate** of any digital channel.
- **Direct and permission-based** — the recipient asked to hear from you.

4.4 Disadvantages and Liabilities

- **Spam and legal risk** — filters block messages, and anti-spam legislation carries severe penalties.
- **Engagement decay** — constant tweaking is required to prevent list fatigue.
- **Code rendering** — appearance breaks across varying e-mail clients, servers and settings, for example when images are blocked by default.
- **Hidden costs** — scaling campaigns requires design, management and software investment, potentially upward of $1,000 per month.
- **Deliverability management** — sender reputation, authentication (SPF, DKIM, DMARC) and list hygiene require ongoing attention.
- **Inbox competition** — the average inbox is crowded, so open rates are structurally limited.

4.5 Opt-In Against Spam

THE LEGAL POINT

The CAN-SPAM Act levies fines of up to **$16,000 per violation** for non-compliance. Permission is not a courtesy; it is a legal requirement. Indian and EU equivalents — the IT Act rules and GDPR — impose comparable obligations.

Table 4.2. Spam against opt-in

	Spam	Opt-In
Acquisition method	Unsolicited; default web checkboxes; purchased lists	Willingly provided via lead forms in exchange for incentives

	Spam	Opt-In
Expectation setting	Blind blasting; unpredictable frequency	Clear promises about e-mail type — sales against tips — and frequency
Brand impact	Degrades reputation; perceived as a nuisance	Builds long-term trust; establishes authority; boosts upsells
List quality	High volume, low intent	Micro-focused, highly targeted engagement

DEFINITION • Single and Double Opt-In

Single opt-in adds the address immediately on submission. ***Double opt-in*** requires the subscriber to confirm through a verification e-mail — producing a smaller but far cleaner and more engaged list, improving deliverability and providing documentary proof of consent.

WHY SEGMENTATION MATTERS IN E-MAIL — 2 MARKS

(SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M) Segmentation divides the list by demographics, purchase history, behaviour, engagement level or lifecycle stage so that each group receives relevant content. It raises open and click rates, reduces unsubscribes and spam complaints, improves deliverability by maintaining engagement, and enables personalisation — which is the single largest driver of e-mail conversion.

4.6 Anatomy of an Effective E-mail

4.6.1 The three rules

THE THREE RULES

1. One topic. Restrict the e-mail to a single marketing message. Multiple messages create a "busy" user experience; focus drives higher revenue per message.

2. Attractive, simple design. The design must complement the message, not distract from it. Design on the assumption that mobile clients may disable images.

3. Clear call to action. The reader must never wonder what to do next; the path to purchase must be frictionless.

THE RESULT OF EXPERIENCE

Continuously A/B test designs and offers in order to learn customer behaviour. No template is permanently correct.

4.6.2 Checklist for an effective marketing e-mail

- A **subject line** that is specific, benefit-led and under about 50 characters — this alone determines the open rate.
- A **recognisable, consistent sender name** — people open based on who sent it as much as on what it says.
- **Preheader text** that extends the subject line rather than repeating it.
- **Personalisation beyond the first name** — reference actual behaviour or past purchases.
- **Above-the-fold value** — the offer must be visible without scrolling.

- A **single, prominent, repeated CTA button** with active verb text.
- **Responsive, mobile-first design** — the majority of opens are on mobile.
- **Alt text on every image**, so the message survives image blocking.
- A **plain-text fallback** version.
- A **visible unsubscribe link** and the sender's physical address — both legally required.
- **Tested rendering** across major clients before sending.

4.7 The Content Arsenal — Nine Types of Marketing E-mail

NAME THE GROUP, NOT JUST THE TYPE

The nine templates fall into three strategic groups. Naming the group and the rules for each type is what separates a full-mark answer from a list.



Figure 4.1. The content arsenal. The group determines the tone and the metric: Group 1 is judged on revenue, Group 2 on engagement, Group 3 on response rate.

4.7.1 Group 1 — drive revenue

Table 4.3. Group 1: revenue e-mails

Type	Goal	Rules
Promotional	Entice immediate purchase	Keep it short; make the offer front and centre; create a sense of urgency with active language
New Inventory	Alert customers to new arrivals	Send immediately upon arrival; prioritise a strong product photograph; minimise text; tease the reveal in the subject line
Reorder	Replenish consumables	Make the buying process simple with a "Reorder Now" button; remind them of the value and the hassle avoided; explicitly mention past purchases

4.7.2 Group 2 — build relationships

Table 4.4. Group 2: relationship e-mails

Type	Goal	Rules
Newsletter	Improve brand awareness	Think "mini-newspaper"; break copy into digestible sections; use simple layouts; always include contact information

Type	Goal	Rules
Welcome	Establish a relationship with new opt-ins	Use a warm, conversational tone — a "virtual handshake"; offer a reward such as 10% off; remind them of the benefits of joining
Educational	Build trust through industry knowledge	Offer relevant, bite-sized information linking out to full blog posts; include a subtle mini-promotion
Product Advice	Establish authority	Solve customer problems; teach product features; emphasise customer service; proofread meticulously to protect credibility

4.7.3 Group 3 — gather intelligence

Table 4.5. Group 3: intelligence e-mails

Type	Goal	Rules
Testimonials	Reinforce business value through social proof	Use a sleek design to frame quotes; pair text with powerful images — customer photographs or product shots; offer a link for readers to leave their own feedback
Surveys	Collect data to improve customer experience	Clearly explain the incentive, such as a prize draw; explicitly address why the data is being collected; provide a highly visible, clickable access button

4.8 Transactional Against Promotional E-mail

HIGH YIELD

"Describe the difference between transactional emails and promotional emails. Provide examples of each and explain when to use them." (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q6a — 8 M)

Table 4.6. Transactional against promotional e-mail

Basis	Transactional E-mail	Promotional E-mail
Trigger	A specific action or event performed by the individual user	A marketing calendar or campaign decision
Purpose	To deliver information the user expects and needs	To generate awareness, demand or sales
Consent required	Implied by the transaction itself	Explicit opt-in required
Volume	One-to-one, automated	One-to-many, batched or segmented
Open rate	Very high, often 40–60% or more, because it is expected	Much lower, typically 15–25%

Basis	Transactional E-mail	Promotional E-mail
Examples	Order confirmation, shipping and delivery notification, password reset, one-time password, invoice or receipt, account creation, appointment reminder	Sale announcement, newsletter, new-product launch, seasonal offer, webinar invitation, re-engagement campaign
When to use	Immediately after the triggering event — speed and clarity matter more than design	At planned intervals against a content calendar, targeted to segments

A PRACTICAL POINT WORTH MARKS

Because transactional e-mails are opened far more often, a small, tasteful promotional element — a related-product strip or a loyalty reminder — *inside* them often outperforms an entire promotional campaign.

But the transactional content must remain dominant, or the message loses its legal status as transactional and becomes subject to opt-in rules.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

E-mail marketing delivers commercial and relationship messages to a permission-based list in order to acquire, engage, convert and retain. It is the only major owned channel, which is why it has the highest conversion and retention rate. E-mail 2.0 replaces one-way blasts and static auto-responders with behavioural triggers, segmentation and lifecycle automation. Its advantages are cost, speed, tracking, personalisation, reach and ownership; its liabilities are legal risk, engagement decay, rendering inconsistency, hidden cost, deliverability management and inbox competition. Opt-in differs from spam in acquisition, expectation, brand impact and list quality; double opt-in produces a smaller and cleaner list. An effective e-mail keeps to one topic, a simple design and one clear call to action. The nine templates group into revenue, relationship and intelligence. Transactional e-mail is user-triggered, expected and opened two to three times as often as promotional e-mail, which is calendar-driven and requires explicit consent.

CHAPTER 5

The E-mail Plan

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

E-mail Plan.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- The seven-node e-mail marketing plan, and why it is a loop.
- A worked plan for a stated scenario.
- The eight-step guide to segmentation and personalisation.

5.1 The Seven Nodes

THE FRAMEWORK FOR EVERY "DESIGN AN E-MAIL PLAN" QUESTION

There have been several such questions, and each is answered by walking these seven nodes against the specific business given. (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)



Figure 5.1. The seven nodes form a loop, not a line. Node 7 feeds back into Node 1.

Table 5.1. The seven nodes in detail

Node	Action
1. Choose software	Select a CRM or e-mail service provider based on the capabilities required — a simple database sender against full behavioural campaign automation
2. Build the list	Start capturing addresses; commit to quality over quantity; limit sending to a maximum of about two e-mails per month initially
3. Capture forms	Deploy sign-up forms on the website and blog to gather names, e-mail addresses and phone numbers
4. Define goals	Determine the mission — deepen relationships, educate the audience, or drive sales cycles

Node	Action
5. Set auto-responders	Build a sequence of at least six educational, non-salesy e-mails released automatically to new subscribers
6. Add triggers	Automate new sales cycles based on specific user actions — for example clicking a particular link, or abandoning a cart
7. Monitor metrics	Review reporting monthly to test subject lines and improve click-through rate — and feed the insight back into Node 1

5.2 Worked Plan — a New Online Business Targeting College Students

OFFICIAL SCHEME ANSWER — 10 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M) **Objective:** increase awareness, engagement and sales among college students. **Target audience:** college students aged 18–25.

1. **Build the e-mail list** — collect e-mails through website sign-ups; offer discounts and free resources.
2. **Create attractive content** — use youthful, creative designs; include offers, contests and product updates.
3. **Segmentation** — segment users based on interests and purchase behaviour.
4. **Personalisation** — use customer names and personalised recommendations.
5. **Campaign schedule** — send weekly newsletters and promotional e-mails.
6. **Mobile optimisation** — ensure e-mails are mobile-friendly.
7. **Performance tracking** — track open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate and unsubscribe rate.

5.3 Segmentation and Personalisation, Step by Step

HIGH YIELD

"Describe the importance of audience segmentation and personalization in email marketing. Provide a step-by-step guide on how to segment an audience effectively and personalize email content based on segmentation criteria." (CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M)

1. **Collect the right data at capture** — ask only for what you will use, then enrich progressively over time.
2. **Choose segmentation criteria** — demographics (age, location, gender); firmographics for B2B (industry, company size, role); behaviour (pages viewed, products browsed, past purchases, cart abandonment); engagement level (active, lapsing, dormant); lifecycle stage (new subscriber, first-time buyer, repeat customer, advocate); and preference (the topics and frequency the subscriber selected).
3. **Build the segments** in the e-mail service provider as *dynamic rules*, so that membership updates automatically.
4. **Design content per segment** — a different subject line, offer, imagery and call to action for each.
5. **Layer personalisation inside the segment** — merge tags for the name, dynamic product blocks based on browsing history, location-specific offers, and send-time optimisation.

6. **Automate lifecycle triggers** — welcome series, browse abandonment, cart abandonment, post-purchase, replenishment, win-back.
7. **Test** — A/B test subject lines and offers *within* each segment, since what works for one will not work for another.
8. **Measure per segment**, and prune or re-engage the segments that consistently underperform.

> **A FASHION RETAILER SEGMENTING BY PAST CATEGORY**
>
> Subscribers who bought running shoes receive a new-arrivals e-mail featuring running gear with the subject line "New for your next 10K", while subscribers who bought formal wear receive an entirely different creative.
>
> The same send, two segments — and typically double the click-through rate of a single generic blast.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

The e-mail plan has seven nodes — choose software, build the list, deploy capture forms, define goals, set auto-responders, add behavioural triggers, and monitor metrics — and Node 7 loops back to Node 1. Applied to a scenario, the plan becomes a specific answer: list building, creative, segmentation, personalisation, schedule, mobile optimisation and tracking. Segmentation and personalisation run in eight steps: collect the right data, choose criteria, build dynamic segments, design per-segment content, layer personalisation inside the segment, automate lifecycle triggers, test within segments, and measure per segment.

CHAPTER 6

E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- What campaign analysis means.
- The six-stage measurement funnel, with formulas.
- How to read each KPI, what a poor reading means, and the fix.
- The challenges of running e-mail campaigns, with paired solutions.
- Two concrete strategies for raising open and click rates.

6.1 What Campaign Analysis Means

MODEL ANSWER — 2 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M) Campaign analysis in e-mail marketing refers to evaluating the performance of e-mail campaigns using metrics such as open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, bounce rate and unsubscribe rate, in order to determine campaign effectiveness and improve future campaigns.

6.2 The Measurement Funnel

The funnel runs from the top of the list to the bottom line. Each stage narrows, and each has its own formula and diagnostic meaning.

Table 6.1. The six-stage measurement funnel

Stage	Definition or formula	What it diagnoses
1. Sent e-mails	The starting list volume. Metric: list growth rate	Whether the audience asset is growing or decaying
2. Delivery (non-bounce rate)	100% − (bounced ÷ total sent). Accounts for invalid addresses or full firewalls	List hygiene and sender reputation
3. Open rate	Tracked when images render on the server or links are clicked. Calculated from the non-bounce pool	The strength of the subject line, sender name and send timing

Stage	Definition or formula	What it diagnoses
4. Click-through rate	The percentage of opens that clicked a link. Used to track interests and A/B test variations	The relevance of the content and the clarity of the call to action
5. Conversion rate	The percentage of clicks that completed the ultimate goal — purchasing, filling a form	The quality of the offer and the landing page
6. Revenue per message	total revenue ÷ number of sent e-mails	The single bottom-line measure of the whole programme

DEFINE CLICK-THROUGH RATE — 2 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M) Click-through rate is the percentage of recipients who click on links in an e-mail compared to the total number of *delivered* e-mails.

TWO DENOMINATORS, TWO NAMES

The lecture material defines CTR against *opens*; the scheme of valuation defines it against *delivered* e-mails. The industry distinguishes these as **click-to-open rate** and **click-through rate** respectively.

State the formula you are using and either is defensible. Stating no formula is what loses the mark.

6.3 Interpreting the KPIs

HIGH YIELD

"Analyse the effectiveness of an E-mail Marketing campaign using KPIs such as open rate, click-through rate, unsubscribe rate, and conversion rate." (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M) Anchor the answer in the six-stage funnel above, so that the KPIs appear as a connected system rather than a list.

Table 6.2. Reading the e-mail KPIs

KPI	What it measures	What a poor reading means	Fix
Open rate	How many users opened the e-mail	Weak subject line, wrong send time, poor sender reputation	Test subject lines; clean the list; authenticate the domain
Click-through rate	How many users clicked links in the e-mail	Content not engaging, or the call to action unclear	Improve the offer; make one CTA dominant; segment better
Unsubscribe rate	Users opting out of e-mails	Content is irrelevant, or frequency is too high	Send relevant content; offer a preference centre instead of only "unsubscribe"
Conversion rate	Users completing the desired action	The offer or landing page is failing, not the e-mail	Fix message match on the landing page; reduce form friction

KPI	What it measures	What a poor reading means	Fix
Bounce rate	Undelivered e-mails	Stale or purchased list; server blocks	Remove hard bounces immediately; use double opt-in
Spam complaint rate	Recipients marking the e-mail as junk	Consent is unclear, or expectations were not set	Set expectations at sign-up; make unsubscribe obvious

THE DIAGNOSTIC LOGIC

Read the funnel downward and the failure locates itself. Clicks but no conversions is *not* an e-mail problem — the e-mail did its job and handed the visitor to a page that failed. Opens but no clicks *is* an e-mail problem: the subject line promised something the body did not deliver.

6.4 Challenges and Solutions

OFFICIAL SCHEME ANSWER — 10 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)

Table 6.3. E-mail marketing challenges and solutions

Challenge	Solution
Low open rates	Use attractive subject lines
Spam filtering issues	Avoid spam words and maintain sender reputation
High unsubscribe rates	Send relevant and useful content
Poor e-mail design	Use responsive e-mail templates
Lack of personalisation	Segment the audience and personalise e-mails
Inactive subscribers	Run re-engagement campaigns

Additional challenges worth naming: deliverability and inbox placement; ***list decay*** of roughly 20–25% per year; rendering inconsistency across clients; privacy changes such as mail privacy protection that inflate open rates and make them unreliable; and a rising regulatory burden.

6.5 Raising Open and Click Rates

TWO STRATEGIES — 2 MARKS, FOR A FASHION BRAND'S SUMMER SALE

(CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M)

- **To increase open rate:** write a specific, urgency-bearing, personalised subject line and A/B test it — for example "Priya, your summer edit is 40% off — today only" — and optimise the send time to the segment's historical open window.
- **To increase click-through rate:** use a single dominant, benefit-led call-to-action button above the fold, supported by a strong hero product image and segmented product recommendations based on the recipient's browsing history.

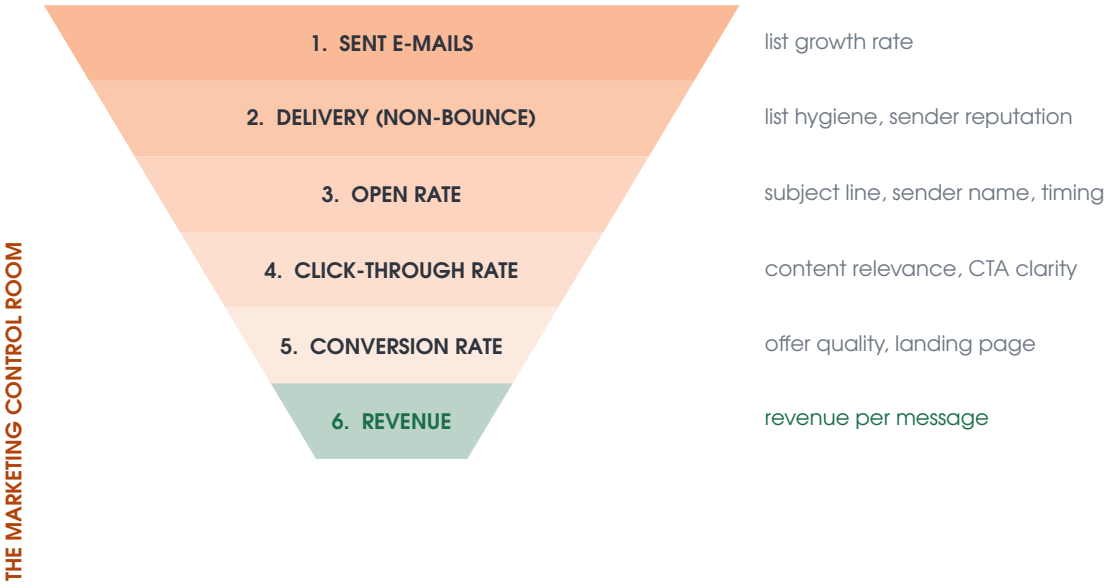


Figure 6.1. The measurement funnel. Each stage has a distinct diagnosis, so a fall in revenue can be traced to exactly one narrowing — which is why the funnel must be read as a system rather than as six separate numbers.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Campaign analysis evaluates e-mail performance on open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, bounce rate and unsubscribe rate in order to improve future campaigns. The measurement funnel has six stages — sent, delivered, opened, clicked, converted, revenue — each with a formula and a distinct diagnosis, so a fall in revenue traces to exactly one narrowing. Each KPI has a characteristic failure and a matching fix, and the key diagnostic distinction is that clicks without conversions indicts the landing page while opens without clicks indicts the e-mail. Six standard challenges pair with six solutions, and to those should be added deliverability, list decay of 20–25% a year, rendering inconsistency and privacy changes that make open rate unreliable.

CHAPTER 7

Measuring Conversions and Keeping Up

SYLLABUS EXTRACT

Measuring Conversions & keeping up.

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COVERS

- How to track conversions that happen offline.
- How to integrate web analytics with e-mail marketing.
- The E-mail 2.0 technology stack.
- Responsive e-mail design — the case, the method and the critical view.
- The four pillars of the e-mail engine.

7.1 Bridging the Gap — Offline Tracking

When open rates and click-through rates are not enough to track overall marketing success, e-mail requires physical participation mechanisms.

Table 7.1. Tracking conversions that happen offline

Mechanism	How it is tracked
In-store purchases	By requesting the customer's e-mail address at the physical point of sale and matching it against the campaign list
Phone calls	By providing dedicated phone numbers exclusive to the e-mail campaign
Event attendance	By issuing special entrance codes that can only be accessed and viewed from within the e-mail itself

THE DIGITAL EQUIVALENTS OF THE SAME PRINCIPLE

Unique promotion codes per campaign; UTM-tagged links feeding web analytics; and printable or scannable QR coupons that carry a campaign identifier. In every case the mechanism is the same: give this campaign, and only this campaign, a token that can be counted later.

7.2 Integrating Web Analytics and E-mail Marketing

OFFICIAL SCHEME ANSWER — 10 MARKS

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)

1. **Collect customer data** — use web analytics tools to track user behaviour, page visits and purchase history.
2. **Audience segmentation** — segment users based on interests and browsing behaviour.
3. **Personalised e-mail campaigns** — send customised e-mails with relevant product recommendations.
4. **Track campaign performance** — use open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate and bounce rate.
5. **Retargeting** — send follow-up e-mails to abandoned-cart users.
6. **Continuous optimisation** — analyse campaign data and improve content and timing.

Benefits: better customer engagement; higher conversion rates; improved customer retention; increased sales and revenue.

7.3 The E-mail 2.0 Technology Stack

Table 7.2. The e-mail technology stack

Category	Tools
CRM and all-in-one automation	HubSpot (automated workflows), Infusionsoft (purchase behaviour and task management), ActiveCampaign (lifecycle automation), Contactually (social and inbox vetting)
Drip campaigns and nurturing	Drip (lightweight workflow builder), ConvertKit (automation rules for publishers), Emma (personalisation via CRM sync), Campaign Monitor (interactive analytics), Sendloop
Creation and standard sending	MailChimp (abandoned carts, groups), GetResponse (calendar-integrated auto-responders), AWeber (new-subscriber catch-up), Reach Mail (simultaneous comparison of five campaigns)
Specialised utility	Litmus (one-click render testing across around 40 clients), BombBomb (video-powered e-mail), Gumroad (digital product updates), Intercom (in-app conversations)
Sales tracking plugins	GetNotify (invisible open tracking), ToutApp (playbooks and CRM sync), Yesware (prescriptive analytics, team tracking), Clearslide (web engagement tracking)

7.4 Responsive E-mail Design

HIGH YIELD

"Evaluate the effectiveness of responsive email design in maintaining a competitive edge in digital marketing." (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q6a — 8 M) The verb is *evaluate*, so the answer must reach a judgement rather than merely describe the technique.

7.4.1 The case for it

The majority of e-mail opens now occur on mobile, and a non-responsive e-mail requiring pinch-and-zoom is typically deleted within seconds. Responsive design therefore protects open-to-click conversion, reduces unsubscribes, improves accessibility, and preserves brand perception. It also improves deliverability indirectly, because engagement signals feed inbox placement algorithms.

7.4.2 How it is achieved

- Fluid single-column layouts and media queries.
- Scalable images.
- Body text of at least 14 to 16 pixels.
- Tap targets of at least 44 by 44 pixels.
- "Bulletproof" call-to-action buttons built in HTML rather than as images.
- Alt text, for image-blocked clients.

7.4.3 The critical view

RESPONSIVENESS IS TABLE STAKES, NOT A DIFFERENTIATOR

Every competent competitor has responsive e-mail, so it prevents disadvantage more than it creates advantage.

Genuine competitive edge comes from **segmentation, personalisation, behavioural triggers and offer quality**. Responsive design is the *precondition* that allows those to work.

It also adds testing overhead across dozens of clients — hence render-testing tools — and dark-mode rendering remains inconsistent.

7.5 Operating the Engine — Four Pillars

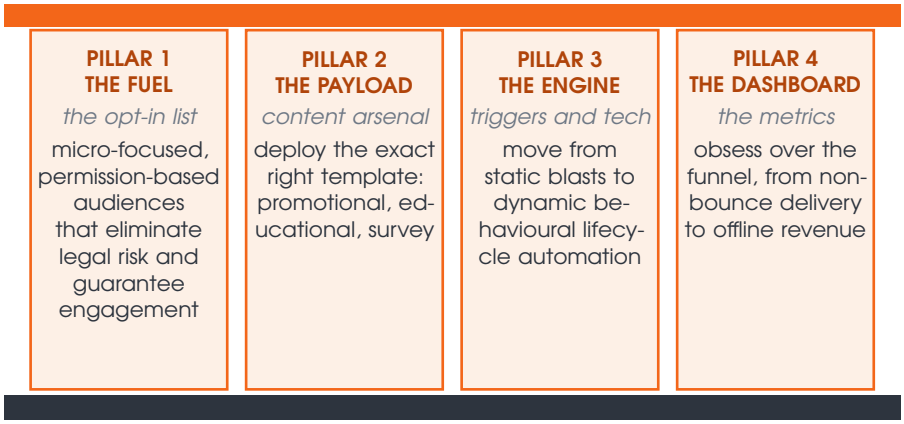


Figure 7.1. The four pillars. Remove any one and the engine stalls: a perfect template sent to a purchased list is illegal, and a perfectly automated programme without a dashboard cannot be improved.

Table 7.3. The four pillars

Pillar	What it means
1 — The Fuel (opt-in list)	Cultivate micro-focused, permission-based audiences, to eliminate the legal risk and guarantee engagement
2 — The Payload (content arsenal)	Deploy the exact right template — promotional to drive revenue, educational to build trust, surveys to gather intelligence
3 — The Engine (triggers and tech)	Use the technology stack to move from static blasts to dynamic, behavioural, lifecycle automation
4 — The Dashboard (metrics)	Obsess over the measurement funnel — from non-bounce delivery down to total offline revenue generation

THE CLOSING IDEA

E-mail marketing is no longer a megaphone. It is a targeted, measurable, high-ROI ecosystem.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Conversions that happen offline are tracked by giving each campaign a countable token: an e-mail address captured at the point of sale, a dedicated phone number, an e-mail-only entrance code, or their digital equivalents in promotion codes, UTM tags and QR coupons. Web analytics and e-mail integrate in six steps — collect behavioural data, segment, personalise, track performance, retarget abandoners, and optimise continuously — yielding better engagement, higher conversion, improved retention and increased revenue. The technology stack spans CRM automation, drip nurturing, standard sending, specialised utilities and sales tracking. Responsive design protects open-to-click conversion and is now a precondition rather than a differentiator; the real edge lies in segmentation, personalisation, triggers and offer quality. Four pillars operate the engine: the opt-in list, the content arsenal, the trigger technology and the metrics dashboard.

APPENDIX A

Syllabus-to-Chapter Concordance

This appendix exists so that coverage can be *audited* rather than assumed. The left-hand column reproduces the Unit III syllabus descriptor phrase by phrase, in the order the official document prints it. The right-hand column gives the chapter and section that carries it. Every phrase resolves to a location, and no numbered chapter of this volume contains material that is not traceable to a phrase in this table.

Table A.1. Concordance for Unit III

Syllabus phrase	Where it is covered
First half — Web Analytics & Google Analytics	
Web Analytics the heading concept	Chapter 1 entire. Definition and importance § 1.1; traditional against web-analytics based analysis § 1.2; the three metric families § 1.3; core metrics § 1.4; bounce rate § 1.5; the dual lens § 1.6; the role of web analytics § 1.7; benefits § 1.8; KPI alignment § 1.9; A/B testing and CRO § 1.10.
Google Analytics Tools	Chapter 2 entire. Purpose § 2.1; key features § 2.2; acquisition channels § 2.3; report families § 2.4; setting up and tracking goals § 2.5; Google Tag Manager § 2.6.
Web Analytics Tools	Chapter 3 entire. Tools other than Google Analytics § 3.1; combining quantitative and qualitative tools § 3.2.
Second half — E-mail Marketing	
Effective E-mail Campaigns	Chapter 4 entire. Definition § 4.1; E-mail 1.0 against 2.0 § 4.2; advantages § 4.3; disadvantages § 4.4; opt-in against spam § 4.5; anatomy of an effective e-mail § 4.6; the nine-type content arsenal § 4.7; transactional against promotional § 4.8.
E-mail Plan	Chapter 5 entire. The seven nodes § 5.1; a worked plan § 5.2; segmentation and personalisation § 5.3.
E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis	Chapter 6 entire. What campaign analysis means § 6.1; the measurement funnel § 6.2; interpreting the KPIs § 6.3; challenges and solutions § 6.4; raising open and click rates § 6.5.
Measuring Conversions & keeping up	Chapter 7 entire. Offline tracking § 7.1; integrating analytics with e-mail § 7.2; the technology stack § 7.3; responsive design § 7.4; the four pillars § 7.5.

NO OFF-SYLLABUS APPENDIX IN THIS VOLUME

Unlike Volumes 1 and 2, every topic in the source material for Unit III maps to a phrase in the unit descriptor. Nothing had to be set aside, so this volume has no appendix of supplementary examined topics.

APPENDIX B

Previous-Year Question Bank — Unit III

Every question in this appendix is reproduced from an actual RVCE Marketing Management Continuous Internal Evaluation or Semester End Examination paper for this course. Answers and pointers follow the official schemes of valuation where those were released.

Part A — Two-Mark Questions

1. **Define Web Analytics and mention its importance in digital marketing activities.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M)
   Web analytics is the process of collecting, measuring, analysing and reporting website data to understand and optimise web usage. Importance: it helps understand customer behaviour, measures campaign effectiveness, improves website performance and supports better marketing decisions. *See* § 1.1.

2. **What is Bounce Rate in Web Analytics and how does it affect website performance evaluation? / How bounce rate affects website performance assessment.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M)
   Bounce rate is the percentage of visitors who leave a website after viewing only one page without any interaction. A high bounce rate signals poor content relevance, slow loading, confusing design or mismatched traffic, and correlates with lower conversions — so it acts as an early diagnostic of both content quality and traffic quality. *See* § 1.5.

3. **List any four important features available in Google Analytics for website performance tracking.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M)
   Traffic source analysis; bounce rate measurement; user demographics tracking; conversion and goal tracking. *See* § 2.2.

4. **What is the main purpose of using Google Analytics?** (CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M)
   To collect, measure and report data about website users — who they are, how they arrived, what they did and whether they converted — so that businesses can understand behaviour, evaluate marketing performance and make evidence-based decisions. *See* § 2.1.

5. **Name any two popular web analytics tools other than Google Analytics.** (CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M)
   Adobe Analytics and Matomo. Also acceptable: Webtrends, Mixpanel, Hotjar, Microsoft Clarity, Kissmetrics, Amplitude, SimilarWeb. *See* § 3.1.

6. **Define "Dimensions" and "Metrics" in Google Analytics.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M)
   Dimensions are attributes of the data — qualitative descriptors such as city, device, browser, source and medium, or page path; they form the rows of a report. Metrics are quantitative measurements — sessions, users, pageviews, bounce rate, revenue; they form the columns. *See* § 1.4.

7. **What is meant by campaign analysis in E-mail Marketing?** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M)
   Evaluating the performance of e-mail campaigns using metrics such as open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, bounce rate and unsubscribe rate, to determine effectiveness and improve future campaigns. *See* § 6.1.

8. **Define Click Through Rate (CTR) in E-mail Marketing.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M)
   CTR is the percentage of recipients who click on links in an e-mail compared to the total number of delivered e-mails. *See* § 6.2.

9. **List any four advantages of E-mail Marketing over traditional marketing methods.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M)
   Low cost; global reach; easy performance tracking; personalised communication. *See* § 4.3.

10. **Why is segmentation important in e-mail marketing campaigns?** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025 — 2 M)
    Segmentation divides the list by demographics, behaviour, engagement or lifecycle stage so that each group receives relevant content. It raises open and click rates, reduces unsubscribes and spam complaints, protects deliverability and enables the personalisation that drives conversion. *See* § 4.5.

11. **List any two key components of a successful email marketing campaign.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M)
    A permission-based, well-segmented opt-in list, and a compelling subject line with a single clear call to action. Also acceptable: personalised relevant content; mobile-responsive design; measurable KPIs. *See* § 4.6.

12. **After conducting an email marketing campaign for a travel agency, outline two specific metrics you would analyze to assess the campaign's performance.** (CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M)
    Click-through rate, to judge whether the destinations and offers presented were relevant enough to earn a click; and conversion rate — bookings or enquiry-form completions per click — to judge whether the campaign produced business value rather than merely interest. *See* § 6.3.

13. **You are tasked with creating an effective email campaign to promote a summer sale for a fashion brand. Describe two strategies you would employ to increase open rates and click-through rates.** (CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M)
    A personalised, urgency-bearing, A/B-tested subject line with an optimised send time to raise opens; and a single dominant benefit-led call to action above the fold with segmented product recommendations to raise clicks. *See* § 6.5.

Part B — Eight- and Ten-Mark Questions

1. **Differentiate between traditional marketing analysis and web analytics-based marketing analysis with suitable examples.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)
   Use the comparison table — data collection, speed, accuracy, customer tracking, cost, measurement, sample, attribution and feedback loop — each with an example. *See* § 1.2.

2. **Explain the role of web analytics in digital marketing. How can businesses benefit from analysing website data?** (CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M)
   The eight roles and the seven benefits. *See* § 1.7 and § 1.8.

3. **Develop a basic strategy to set up Google Analytics for a new e-commerce website. What key metrics should be tracked?** (CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M)

Setup strategy: (1) create the property and data stream; (2) deploy the tag through Google Tag Manager rather than hard-coding; (3) define the measurement plan — what business questions must the data answer; (4) configure enhanced e-commerce events (view item, add to cart, begin checkout, purchase); (5) mark purchase and lead events as conversions and assign values; (6) build the checkout funnel exploration; (7) apply UTM tagging conventions to every campaign; (8) link the advertising platform and Search Console; (9) configure internal-traffic and bot filters; (10) set up audiences for remarketing; (11) build a dashboard; (12) validate in debug view and real time before trusting the data. *Key metrics:* sessions and users by channel; new against returning; bounce or engagement rate; average session duration; product views, add-to-cart rate and cart-abandonment rate; checkout completion rate; conversion rate; average order value; revenue; return on advertising spend; and cost per acquisition by channel. *See* § 2.2 and § 2.5.

4. **How can businesses align Web Analytics KPIs with their organizational goals? Illustrate with examples.** (CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M)
   The five-step method with the goal-to-KPI mapping and a SMART example. *See* § 1.9.

5. **Discuss the concept of "Acquisition channels" in Google Analytics. How can business use this information to optimize their marketing efforts?** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q5a — 8 M)
   Define acquisition channels, list them with meaning and optimisation action, and explain the ways businesses act on the data — above all, judging a channel by revenue rather than by traffic. *See* § 2.3.

6. **Explain the significance of A/B testing and conversion rate optimization in Web Analytics. How can these practices help improve website performance?** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q5b — 8 M)
   Definitions, significance, what to test, the six-step process and the tools. *See* § 1.10.

7. **List and explain the various reports that can be generated using Google Analytics.** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q6b — 8 M)
   Real-time, audience and user, acquisition, behaviour and engagement, conversions and monetisation, attribution, and custom reports and explorations. *See* § 2.4.

8. **Describe the process of setting up and tracking goals in Google Analytics. How can businesses use goal tracking to measure website performance?** (SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q10b — 6 M)
   The eight-step process, and the point that goals convert traffic reports into ROI reports. *See* § 2.5.

9. **Design a simple marketing plan for an e-learning platform using insights gathered from web analytics tools.** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q5a — 8 M)
   Insight gathering: analytics shows that most traffic arrives from organic search on mobile, that the highest-engagement pages are free sample lessons, and that 70% of drop-off occurs on the payment page; session recordings show users hesitating at a nine-field sign-up form. *Plan:* (1) objective — increase paid enrolments by 25% in one quarter; (2) audience — segment into browsers, free-trial users and lapsed users; (3) channels — SEO around "learn X online" long-tail queries, video sample lessons, and a re-engagement e-mail sequence; (4) content — the free sample lesson as the lead magnet, since analytics identified it as the strongest engagement asset; (5) conversion fixes — cut the sign-up form to four fields, add trust signals and a money-back guarantee at the payment step, and mobile-optimise checkout; (6) e-mail — trigger a nurture

sequence on free-trial start and an abandoned-checkout reminder; (7) measurement — track enrolment conversion rate, cost per enrolment, checkout completion rate and course-completion retention; review fortnightly. *See* Chapter 1 and Chapter 5.

10. **Analyze a failed e-mail marketing campaign and identify areas where marketing research could have improved outcomes.** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q5b — 8 M)
Diagnose against the funnel. *High bounce rate* → the list was purchased or stale; research into list source and hygiene would have prevented it. *Low open rate* → the subject line and sender name were untested; subject-line A/B research would have identified a winner. *Low CTR despite opens* → content was irrelevant to the segment; audience research and segmentation would have matched offer to interest. *Clicks but no conversions* → the landing page did not match the e-mail's promise; message-match testing and usability research would have caught it. *High unsubscribes and spam complaints* → expectations were never set at sign-up and frequency was too high; preference research would have fixed both.

Conclusion: the failure was not a creative failure but a **research failure** — the campaign was designed from assumption rather than from audience data. *See* § 6.2 and § 6.3.

11. **Describe the importance of audience segmentation and personalization in email marketing. Provide a step-by-step guide on how to segment an audience effectively and personalize email content based on segmentation criteria.** (CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M)
The eight-step guide with the fashion-retailer example, preceded by the importance argument. *See* § 5.3 and § 4.5.

12. **Imagine you are a marketing manager for a startup selling organic skincare products. Develop a case study outlining the steps you would take to create and execute an effective e-mail campaign to launch a new product line. Include specific goals, target audience segmentation, content strategy, and metrics for success.** (CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M)
Goals: 3,000 pre-launch sign-ups; 25% open rate; 4% conversion on the launch send; Rs. 8 lakh revenue in the launch fortnight. *Segmentation:* existing customers by past category (cleansers, serums, sun care); engaged non-buyers; customers lapsed over 180 days; and new sign-ups from the pre-launch teaser. *Content strategy — a five-e-mail sequence:* (1) a teaser to the full list, building anticipation with an ingredient story; (2) an educational e-mail on the skin concern the range solves, establishing authority; (3) the launch announcement with a hero product image and a single call to action, personalised by segment; (4) a social-proof e-mail carrying testimonials and before-and-after images; (5) an urgency e-mail for non-openers and cart abandoners with a 48-hour launch offer. Each is mobile-responsive, single-topic, with one dominant call to action. *Execution:* double opt-in capture, dynamic product blocks by segment, send-time optimisation, and A/B tests on subject lines for e-mails 3 and 5. *Metrics:* list growth rate, non-bounce rate, open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, revenue per message, unsubscribe and spam-complaint rate — reviewed after each send so the sequence is optimised mid-flight. *See* Chapter 5 and Chapter 6.

13. **Evaluate the challenges faced in maintaining successful E-mail Marketing campaigns and suggest suitable solutions to improve campaign performance.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)
The six challenges with paired solutions, plus deliverability, list decay, rendering inconsistency and privacy changes. *See* § 6.4.

14. **Create a strategy to integrate Web Analytics and E-mail Marketing for improving customer engagement and business growth.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)
The six-step strategy and the four benefits. *See* § 7.2.

15. **Analyse the effectiveness of an E-mail Marketing campaign using KPIs such as open rate, click-through rate, unsubscribe rate, and conversion rate.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)
Define each KPI, state what a high or low reading indicates, and give the corrective action. Anchor the answer in the six-stage measurement funnel so that the KPIs are shown as a connected system rather than a list. *See* § 6.2 and § 6.3.

16. **Design an E-mail Marketing plan for a newly launched online business targeting college students.** (CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M)
The official seven-point scheme answer. *See* § 5.2.

17. **Evaluate the effectiveness of responsive email design in maintaining a competitive edge in digital marketing.** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q6a — 8 M)
The case for it, how it is achieved, and the critical view that it is now table stakes rather than a differentiator. *See* § 7.4.

18. **Critically evaluate the contribution of Google Tag Manager in optimizing marketing channels for global companies.** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q6b — 8 M)
The six contributions and the four critical limitations. *See* § 2.6.

19. **Demonstrate how tools like Google Analytics and Hotjar can be used to develop insights into user behavior and improve marketing decisions.** (SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q7a — 8 M)
Analytics gives the *what* — which channels deliver traffic, which landing pages bounce, where users drop out of checkout, which segments convert, and what each channel costs per acquisition. Behavioural tools give the *why* — heatmaps show which elements attract attention, scroll maps show whether users ever reach the call to action, click maps expose rage clicks on non-clickable elements, session recordings show hesitation in real time, and on-page surveys capture the reason for abandonment in the user's own words. Then give the combined workflow and the decisions it improves. *See* § 3.2.

How Unit III Is Examined

THE PATTERN ACROSS PAPERS

In the Semester End Examination, Unit III is Questions 5 and 6 with internal choice — 16 marks in two eight-mark sub-divisions — plus two or three Part A objective questions. The second Continuous Internal Evaluation test draws heavily on it.

The highest-probability topics are the **e-mail measurement funnel and KPI analysis**, **designing an e-mail marketing plan** for a given scenario, **segmentation and personalisation**, **Google Analytics reports, goals and acquisition channels**, and **traditional against web-analytics-based analysis**.

Note that almost every Unit III question is *applied* — you will be given a business and asked to build or diagnose something — so always answer with a named framework (the seven-node plan, the six-stage funnel, the eight-step goal setup) rather than general commentary.

APPENDIX C

Glossary of Key Terms

Table C.1. Key terms for rapid revision

Term	One-line meaning
A/B testing	Splitting traffic between two versions to find the statistically better one
Acquisition channel	The grouping describing where a session came from
Auto-responder	An automated sequence released to new subscribers
Bounce rate (web)	Percentage of visitors who leave after viewing one page without interaction
Bounce rate (e-mail)	Percentage of sent e-mails that were not delivered
Buzz	A combined popularity measure across social mentions
CAN-SPAM	US anti-spam law; fines up to $16,000 per violation
Campaign analysis	Evaluating e-mail performance on opens, clicks, conversions, bounces and unsubscribes
CRO	Conversion rate optimisation — systematically raising the percentage who convert
CTR	Percentage of recipients, or of opens, who clicked a link
Dimension	An attribute of the data — city, device, source; forms the rows of a report
Double opt-in	Consent confirmed through a verification e-mail
Drip campaign	A scheduled nurture sequence delivered over time
E-mail marketing	Using e-mail to deliver commercial and relationship messages to a permission-based list
Exit rate	Percentage of sessions that ended on a given page
Funnel visualisation	A report showing drop-off at each step of a defined path
Goal / conversion	A defined, valuable user action being tracked
Google Analytics	The platform that collects, measures and reports website and app user data
Google Tag Manager	A container for deploying and versioning tracking tags without code changes
List decay	The natural annual loss of list quality, roughly 20–25% per year
Metric	A quantitative measurement — sessions, revenue; forms the columns of a report
Non-bounce rate	100% minus bounced over total sent — the delivery rate
Open rate	Percentage of delivered e-mails opened
Opt-in	Permission willingly given to receive e-mail
Pageviews	Total pages loaded; unique pageviews counts a page once per session

Term	One-line meaning
Revenue per message	Total revenue divided by the number of sent e-mails
Segment	An isolated subset of users defined by shared attributes or behaviour
Session	A group of user interactions within a given time frame
Share of voice	Conversations about you against conversations about competitors
Transactional e-mail	A user-triggered informational e-mail — receipt, one-time password, shipping notice
Trigger	An automated e-mail fired by a specific user action
Unsubscribe rate	Percentage of recipients who opted out
Web analytics	Collecting, measuring, analysing and reporting website data to understand and optimise web usage

APPENDIX D

Framework Quick-Reference Sheet

Everything in this volume that is a numbered list, in one place, for the night before the examination.

Table D.1. Framework quick reference

Framework	The sequence
Three metric families	Volume (are we seen?), quality (are we relevant?), action (are they engaging?)
Traditional against web analytics	Data collection, speed, accuracy, customer tracking, cost, measurement, sample, attribution, feedback loop
Bounce against exit	Bounce is a single-page no-interaction session; exit is the last page of any session
Dimensions and metrics	Attributes form the rows; numbers form the columns
Eight roles of web analytics	Effectiveness, behaviour, conversion, budget, content, technical, segmentation, forecasting
Seven benefits	Conversion, acquisition cost, experience, problem detection, content decisions, ROI proof, competitive advantage
KPI alignment (five steps)	Identify goals → map to KPIs → make SMART → instrument analytics → optimise continuously
CRO process	Find the weakest step → hypothesise → build the variant → split traffic → run to significance → implement → repeat
Four GA features to name	Traffic source analysis, bounce rate, demographics, conversion and goal tracking
Nine acquisition channels	Organic search, paid search, direct, referral, organic social, paid social, e-mail, display, affiliates
Seven report families	Real-time, audience, acquisition, behaviour, conversions, attribution, custom and explorations
Goal setup (eight steps)	Define the conversion → choose the type → implement → assign value → configure the funnel → verify → track → act
Tag Manager — for and against	Faster deployment, standard data layer, consent, page weight, experimentation, rollback *against* tag sprawl, duplicate firing, performance, security
What against why	Analytics locates the drop-off; heatmaps, recordings and surveys explain it
E-mail 1.0 against 2.0	One-way, static, batch, untracked *against* triggered, segmented, automated, measured
Four e-mail advantages	Low cost, global reach, easy tracking, personalised communication

Framework	The sequence
Opt-in against spam	Acquisition method, expectation setting, brand impact, list quality
Three e-mail rules	One topic, simple design complementing the message, one clear call to action
Nine e-mail types	Revenue: promotional, new inventory, reorder. Relationships: newsletter, welcome, educational, product advice. Intelligence: testimonials, surveys
Transactional against promotional	Trigger, purpose, consent, volume, open rate (40–60% against 15–25%), examples, timing
Seven-node e-mail plan	Software → list → capture forms → goals → auto-responders → triggers → metrics → back to software
Segmentation (eight steps)	Collect data → choose criteria → build dynamic segments → design per segment → personalise within → automate triggers → test within → measure per segment
Six-stage measurement funnel	Sent → delivered → opened → clicked → converted → revenue per message
Six e-mail challenges	Low opens, spam filtering, unsubscribes, poor design, no personalisation, inactive subscribers
Offline tracking	Point-of-sale e-mail capture, dedicated phone numbers, e-mail-only entrance codes; promo codes, UTM tags, QR coupons
Analytics–e-mail integration	Collect → segment → personalise → track → retarget → optimise
Four pillars	The fuel (opt-in list), the payload (content arsenal), the engine (triggers and tech), the dashboard (metrics)

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